

SKILLING IN 5G TECHNOLOGY Holds A Great Promise



India is at the threshold of a big revolution as the highly-anticipated 5G network is finally taking shape in the country. But do we recognise the potential it holds for the electronics industry? And are we getting ready the biggest asset at our disposal—the manpower—at the required speed? Is it possible to take our rightful place in this world without the skilled manpower?

TELECOM SECTOR
SKILL COUNCIL and
SIDDHA DHAR

Telecom Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw successfully tested India's first 5G audio and video call in May this year. "Successfully tested 5G call at IIT Madras. Entire end to end network is designed and developed in India," he tweeted.

As with any new technology, 5G brings with it opportunities and the promise of employment.

The Telecom Sector Skill Council (TSSC) estimates that India will require as many as 22 million skilled manpower by 2025 to reap the full potential of 5G. This is easier said than done.

India is infamous for missing the bus of both the 4G revolution and the electronics manufacturing era in the past. And it can be attributed mostly to one reason—the lack of awareness of the opportunities and the challenges we face. Skilling the youth

is a prime example of that.

"The future doesn't lie in the job, it lies in the person doing the job," says Ramesh Kasetty, CEO and Co-founder, Duranc.

A robust telecom sector for a robust electronics industry

The telecom industry no longer sits in the back seat of reforms. The introduction of 5G promises a gleaming future for the industry. This is the result of a long-awaited realisation—a robust electronics and technology industry requires a robust telecom infrastructure.

"The kind of new technologies that are coming, it is not possible to take advantage of that tech without having a robust telecom infrastructure underneath," notes Dr N.S. Kalsi, Chairman, NCVET. Technology is only as good as the hands that use it. The first step to skilling the manpower is